



Just Jammin'

When it comes to setting your PC afire with music and visuals, these little guys pull no punches. So choose well while selecting your media player

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interactive

8 media players for movie and audio playback on your PC, tested and reviewed. Check out
Mindware

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The digital generation sure knows to rock...from music players, MP3s and DVDs to the latest interactive videos, we've come a long way. If you're in need of a second opinion about the latest movie releases, any teenybopper out there could give you an animated version with a crisper storyline on how the 'Star Wars' trilogy could have been better or how the music director could have improved the musical score in *Final Fantasy*. And it's even more likely that they would have seen the pre release ages ago. All thanks to the Net. What's more, if you need any grounding on technology, you can expect nothing less than a running commentary.

The music makers

Well, life sure does move fast here. Gone are the days of listening to songs on a cobalt tape. This is the age of DVDs and making merry on your PC.

Almost everyone today plays music on his or her PC. This could be in the form of regular music CDs or even one of the increasingly popular digital music formats such as Wav, MP3, Ogg Vorbis, WMA, or RealAudio. MP3 stands out from the rest—a universally accepted format that has been glorified by all and sundry.

Different people have different expectations from their audio playback software. You will find die-hard loyalists such as Shashank Robby, who swear by Winamp for the simple reason that "it has the largest library of plugins one can think of".

Winamp is very popular amongst users because it is light on system resources, easy to use, and has some really sleek skins. Says Rhean D'Souza, a student, "To play music I use only Winamp because it has numerous features and is very user friendly. I prefer the MP3 format because it's very neat and compact and I can almost store a DJ station on my PC. Besides, they